

DBS Group (DBSM.SI)

1Q25 review: well-prepared, confident to maintain PBT stable; Buy

Buy

DBSM.SI 12m Price Target: **S\$50.20** Price: **S\$43.09** Upside: **16.5%**

DBS posted 1Q25 net profit of S\$2,897mn, -4%yoy/+10%qoq, inline with GSe (see [First Take: 1Q25 inline robust non-NII offset higher GPs taken; largely affirms 2025 outlook](#)). Overall, management's tone at the analyst briefing was one of cautious optimism, reiterating that the previous guidance remains unchanged, provided more details (see below) and added that previously guided PBT to be stable from 2024 (which was left out in the presentation slides) remained unchanged. On the provisioning, DBS sees current management overlay of S\$2.6bn as adequate to cushion macro uncertainties and see no necessity to add more unless macro environment severely deteriorate vs their stress test scenario. Management also provided updates on the capital management in which DBS sees itself capable to sustain S\$0.24 DPS step up in next 2-3 years if ROE is maintained at 15%-17%. Additionally, they remain committed to returning S\$8bn of excess capital as previously announced, and note that further excess capital accumulated over the years will be returned after the completion of the committed current plans. Overall, we see this as a robust set of results, with steady performance across operation lines, and the confidence from management noting that the all-around capabilities of DBS together with its solid balance sheet, and robust funding franchise will help them navigate through these macro uncertainties.

Post results, we revise up our 2025/26/27E net income estimates by +2.2%/+2.0%/+2.3% to S\$10,607/S\$10,695mn/ S\$11,245mn as we bake in higher NIM in 1Q25, and higher fee but partly offset by higher CoC. Our 12-m target price is revised up to S\$50.2 (based on 2-staged DDM) from S\$49.8 previously. Key risks: (-) Unexpected acceleration in rate cuts; (-) Unexpected asset quality deterioration; (-) Mismanaged top management transition. We maintain our Buy

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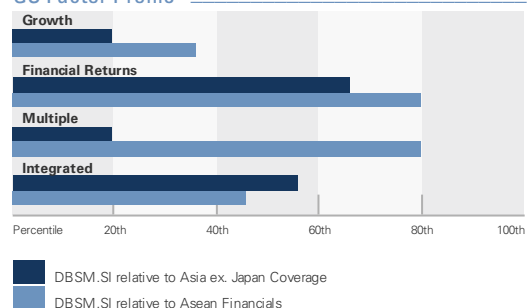
Key Data

Market cap: S\$121.6bn / \$94.2bn
3m ADTV: S\$265.7mn / \$199.3mn
Singapore
Asean Financials
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Net inc. (S\$ mn) New	11,409.0	10,607.4	10,695.1	11,244.8
Net inc. (S\$ mn) Old	11,409.0	10,380.5	10,484.8	10,986.7
EPS (S\$) New	4.01	3.76	3.82	4.05
EPS (S\$) Old	4.01	3.68	3.75	3.95
EPS growth (%)	10.9	(6.2)	1.7	5.9
P/E (X)	8.9	11.5	11.3	10.6
P/B (X)	1.5	1.8	1.8	1.8
Price/PPOP (X)	9.1	9.2	9.2	8.7
Dividend yield (%)	6.2	7.1	7.7	8.2
	3/25	6/25E	9/25E	12/25E
EPS (S\$)	1.02	0.97	0.93	0.83

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
See disclosures for details.

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Buy

DBS Group (DBSM.SI)

Rating since Sep 1, 2024

Ratios & Valuation

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
P/E (X)	8.9	11.5	11.3	10.6
Price/PPOP (X)	9.1	9.2	9.2	8.7
P/B (X)	1.5	1.8	1.8	1.8
P/NTA per share (X)	—	—	—	—
Dividend yield (%)	6.2	7.1	7.7	8.2
Div. payout ratio (%)	55.4	81.4	86.4	87.5

Growth & Margins (%)

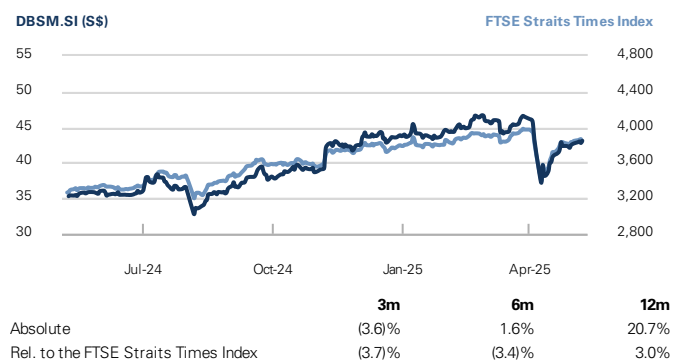
	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
BVPS growth	11.3	1.2	1.7	1.6
Total revenue growth	10.5	1.0	1.7	5.0
Op. profit growth	10.5	(1.0)	0.1	5.4
Net inc growth	10.9	(7.0)	0.8	5.1
EPS growth	10.9	(6.2)	1.7	5.9
DPS growth	27.2	37.8	7.8	7.3

Asset Quality

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Provision charge/total loans (%)	0.1	0.2	0.2	0.2
Gr impaired assets/total loans (%)	1.1	1.1	1.2	1.2
NPL ratio (%)	1.1	1.1	1.2	1.2
Total provisions/total loans (%)	1.4	1.5	1.5	1.5
Specific prov/gr impair assets (%)	50.1	51.1	52.3	53.9
Loan loss reserve/NPLs (%)	127.4	126.9	124.3	122.1

Capital Item

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Basel 3 CET1 ratio (%)	—	—	—	—
Tier 1 capital ratio (%)	17.7	16.8	16.4	15.9

Price Performance

Source: FactSet. Price as of 8 May 2025 close.

Income Statement (\$\$ mn)

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Net interest income	14,424.0	14,407.7	13,768.3	13,952.9
Net fees	4,168.0	4,755.2	5,418.6	6,197.1
Treasury income	3,381.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Other operating income	324.0	3,350.0	3,710.0	3,895.5
Total revenue	22,297.0	22,513.0	22,897.0	24,045.6
Compensation & benefits exp.	(5,594.0)	—	—	—
Non-employee costs	(3,301.0)	(9,250.8)	(9,620.8)	(10,053.8)
Pre-provision op. profit	13,402.0	13,262.2	13,276.2	13,991.8
Provision for loans	(623.0)	(999.0)	(917.7)	(997.6)
Total provision expense	(622.0)	(999.0)	(917.7)	(997.6)
Income/(loss) from associates	250.0	287.5	296.1	310.9
Pre-tax profit	13,007.0	12,550.7	12,654.6	13,305.1
Provision for taxes	(1,599.0)	(1,945.4)	(1,961.5)	(2,062.3)
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	11,409.0	10,607.4	10,695.1	11,244.8
Post-tax exceptionals	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	11,409.0	10,607.4	10,695.1	11,244.8
EPS (basic, pre-exception) (\$\$)	4.01	3.76	3.82	4.05
EPS (diluted, pre-exception) (\$\$)	--	--	--	--
EPS (basic, post-exception) (\$\$)	--	--	--	--
EPS (diluted, post-exception) (\$\$)	4.01	3.76	3.82	4.05
Wtd avg shares out. (diluted) (mn)	2,846.4	2,822.0	2,799.1	2,778.0
Avg. yield on loans (%)	4.2	4.4	4.1	4.0
Gr yld. on int. earning assets (%)	4.3	3.4	2.9	2.8
Cost of fund (%)	2.5	1.7	1.3	1.2
Net interest margin (%)	2.0	1.8	1.7	1.7

Balance Sheet (\$\$ mn)

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Domestic mortgages	85,746.0	88,612.2	91,578.5	94,981.5
Domestic non-mortgages	41,579.0	42,968.9	44,407.2	46,057.4
Domestic commercial lending	273,334.0	282,470.7	291,926.3	302,774.2
Total overseas lending, gross	240,608.0	451,281.0	466,387.4	483,718.3
Gross loans to customers	436,684.0	451,281.0	466,387.4	483,718.3
Total NPLs, gross	4,780.0	5,165.4	5,571.5	6,020.4
Total loan loss reserve	6,090.0	6,556.2	6,923.2	7,350.8
Net customer loans & advances	430,594.0	444,724.8	459,464.1	476,367.5
Other interest earning assets	105,053.0	105,053.0	105,053.0	105,053.0
Interest earning assets	756,247.0	789,874.2	811,328.5	836,932.8
Other non-int. earning assets	70,972.0	71,387.6	71,814.4	72,258.6
Total assets	827,219.0	861,261.8	883,142.8	909,191.4
Risk weighted assets	352,002.0	362,789.6	375,740.6	390,705.9
CASA deposits	291,066.0	315,806.6	331,596.9	351,492.8
Non-CASA deposits	270,664.0	279,984.6	285,497.1	291,119.8
Customer deposits	561,730.0	595,791.2	617,094.0	642,612.6
Other paying liabilities	—	—	—	—
Other liabilities	63,313.0	63,313.0	63,313.0	63,313.0
Total liabilities	758,386.0	792,208.2	813,511.0	839,029.6
Total shareholders' equity	68,833.0	69,053.6	69,631.8	70,161.8
Total liabilities & equity	827,219.0	861,261.8	883,142.8	909,191.4
BVPS (\$\$)	23.33	23.61	24.01	24.38
RWA/assets (%)	42.6	42.1	42.5	43.0

Profit Drivers

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Net customer loan growth (%)	3.5	3.3	3.3	3.7
Net interest margin (%)	2.0	1.8	1.7	1.7
Fee income ratio (%)	NM	NM	NM	NM
Cost/income (ex. goodwill) (%)	39.9	41.1	42.0	41.8
Tax rate (%)	12.3	15.5	15.5	15.5
CASA ratio (%)	51.8	53.0	53.7	54.7
Net cust. loans/deposits (%)	76.7	74.6	74.5	74.1

Profitability

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Op. revenue/avg. assets (%)	2.8	2.7	2.6	2.7
Op. expenses/avg. assets (%)	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1
Pre-provision ROA (%)	1.7	1.6	1.5	1.6
Loan loss prov./avg. assets (%)	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1
Pre-tax profit/avg. assets (%)	1.7	1.5	1.5	1.5
Prov. for inc. tax/avg. assets (%)	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2
ROA (%)	1.5	1.3	1.2	1.3
Leverage (X)	12.0	12.5	12.7	13.0
ROE (%)	18.1	15.9	16.0	16.7
ROE (pre-exception.) (%)	17.4	15.4	15.4	16.1

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

rating on DBS.

More details from the briefing:

- **Confident to achieve 2025 NII above 2024 level** with the expectation of 3 Fed cuts in 2025. Apr exit NIM was 2.09% and DBS expects 2025 FY NIM to come in a few bps below this, depending on number of rate cuts. DBS iterated that 1/3 of its portfolio is hedged and majority of cash flow hedges will only roll-off by next year. NII sensitivity is unchanged at S\$4mn per 1bps Fed cut. Furthermore, it is encouraging to see that the CASA growth was strong in 1Q25, especially in S\$, on the back of lower interest rate environment and various efforts of DBS. On loan growth, DBS notes that 1Q25 growth was mainly driven by large corporate loan demand and the momentum continued in Apr. DBS has limited visibility on 2H25 loan demand due to the macro uncertainties, however, the bank expects to sustain NII via deploying excess liquidity from CASA growth into high quality investment assets should loan growth decelerate, although this may result in NIM compression. We expect flat NII yoy, with NIM of 2.04% baking in 5 additional Fed rate cuts and loan growth of 3%.
- **Commercial book non-NII in 2025 to deliver mid-to high-single digit growth.** Wealth management delivered robust growth of 35% yoy, on the back of 13% yoy AUM growth and investment deployment rising to 56% of AUM with higher investment in sticky bancassurance products. DBS noted new money inflow remains strong in April and expects structural wealth fee income growth despite the volatile market condition. We forecast total fee income to come in at +14%, driving +3% non-NII growth in 2025E.
- **Asset quality manageable with sufficient buffer.** DBS maintains 2025 SP guidance unchanged at 17-20bps. Asset quality remains sound and DBS estimated only 1%-2% of its portfolio is under first order impact of US tariff and those are mostly large corporate who should see limited downside. On second order impact, DBS remain cautious and need to further access but notes that the bank has been very cautious in past few years and exposure to SME and unsecured consumer loans is S\$12bn/14bn respectively. DBS clarifies that the S\$205mn GP taken in 1Q25 was driven by prudence on the back of robust PPOP while no major higher-than-expected risk was spotted in stress test. DBS considers its S\$2.6bn management overlay as sufficient to cushion macro uncertainties with GP 1% coverage on performing loans and 137% NPL coverage ratio. DBS sees current GP as adequate, and does not rule out the chance to release GP if SP were significantly higher than expected. We raise our forecast 2025E credit cost of 23bps from 23bps.
- **Hold on to capital return plan.** Capital remains robust with fully-loaded CET1 standing at 15.2% by 1Q25, and transitional CET1 at 17.4%. DBS sees itself capable to sustain S\$0.24 DPS step up in next 2-3 years if ROE is maintained at 15%-17%. Additionally, they remain committed to returning S\$8bn of excess capital as previously announced, and note that further excess capital accumulated over the years will be returned after the completion of the committed current plans.

Exhibit 1: DBS 1Q25 Results Summary

Income statement (\$\$mn)						YoY %		QoQ %		Actual vs. Est (%)	
	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25					1Q25E	
Net Interest Income	3,505	3,594	3,597	3,728	3,681	5	(1)			3,725	(1)
Fee & Commission	1,043	1,048	1,109	968	1,275	22	32			1,192	7
Other Non-Interest Income	1,009	840	1,047	809	949	(6)	17			850	12
Non-Interest Income	2,052	1,888	2,156	1,777	2,224	8	25			2,042	9
Operating Income	5,557	5,482	5,753	5,505	5,905	6	7			5,767	2
Operating Expenses	(2,079)	(2,172)	(2,249)	(2,395)	(2,214)	6	(8)			(2,266)	(2)
Pre-Prov Op Profit (PPOP)	3,478	3,310	3,504	3,110	3,691	6	19			3,501	5
Loan Loss Provisions	(135)	(148)	(130)	(209)	(325)	141	56			(219)	48
Pre-tax Profit	3,394	3,213	3,440	2,960	3,437	1	16			3,347	3
Net Profit	3,007	2,733	3,027	2,523	2,897	(4)	15			2,828	2
Core Net Profit	3,007	2,752	3,027	2,623	2,897	(4)	10			2,828	2

Balance sheet (\$\$mn)						YoY %		QoQ %		Actual vs. Est (%)	
	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25					1Q25E	
Assets	783,208	790,111	789,609	827,219	840,823	7	2			832,549	1
Gross Loans	431,000	430,912	424,000	436,684	442,000	2.6	1.2			438,815	1
Non-Performing Loans	4,741	4,754	4,240	4,780	4,862	3	2			4,858	0
Customer Deposits	547,197	551,088	544,961	561,730	575,663	5	2			565,972	2

CAMEL Ratios (%)						YoY %		QoQ %		Actual vs. Est (%)	
	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25					1Q25E	
Core Tier 1	14.7	14.8	15.2	15.1	15.2					15.2	
NPL Ratio	1.10	1.10	1.00	1.09	1.10					1.11	
Loan Provisions / Average Loans (bps)	13	14	12	19	30					20	
Reported Net Interest Margin	2.14	2.14	2.11	2.15	2.12					2.11	
Cost-to-Income Ratio	37.4	39.6	39.1	43.5	37.5					39.3	
Loan-to-Deposits	78.8	78.2	77.8	77.7	76.8					77.5	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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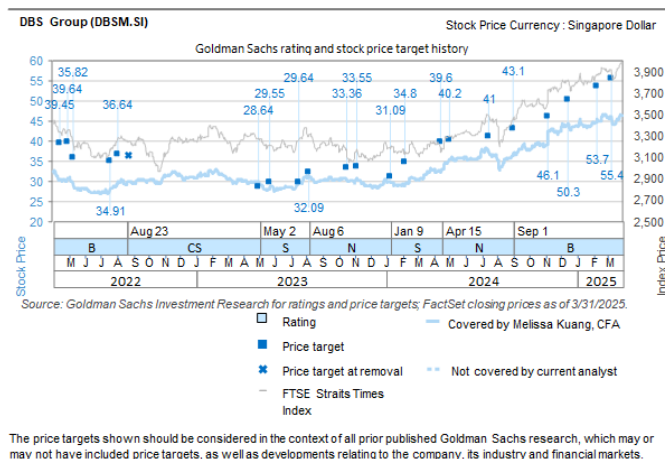
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